

TRUSTORA (SMC-PRIVATE) LIMITED

EMPLOYER OF RECORD (EOR) OPERATIONS & CORPORATE GOVERNANCE POLICY

Effective Date: September 1, 2026

Policy Owner: Executive Management, TRUSTORA (SMC-PRIVATE) LIMITED

Official Web Portal: trustora.net

Official Corporate Contact Email: info@trustora.net

Target Audience: All internal executive officers, permanent employees, client-assigned Employer of Record (EoR) personnel, contractors, and international corporate partners.

1. COMPANY OVERVIEW, LEGAL IDENTITY, AND STATUTORY REGISTRATIONS

1.1 Legal Entity and Structure

TRUSTORA (SMC-PRIVATE) LIMITED ("Trustora", "Company", "we", "us", "our") is a single-member private limited company incorporated and validly existing under the Companies Act, 2017 of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, registered with the Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP). Trustora operates primarily as an Employer of Record (EoR) partner, human capital management firm, and workforce compliance specialist.

1.2 Core Operational Scope

Trustora provides legal employment administration, global payroll processing, talent placement, human resources operations, statutory tax withholding, and workplace compliance management through formal, executed written agreements.

1.3 Statutory Registrations

Trustora maintains active corporate registrations with all required national and provincial statutory authorities, including:

- **Securities and Exchange Commission of Pakistan (SECP):** Corporate incorporation and annual compliance filings.
- **Federal Board of Revenue (FBR):** National Tax Number (NTN) registration and corporate income tax withholdings.
- **Employees' Old-Age Benefits Institution (EOBI):** Federal pension and disability scheme compliance.
- **Provincial Employees' Social Security Institutions:** Social security registration across applicable provincial jurisdictions (including SESSI, PESSI, and IESSI).

1.4 Communication Channels

All official corporate communications, statutory notices, legal complaints, privacy requests, and compliance disclosures must be directed exclusively to info@trustora.net.

2. INTERNATIONAL SERVICE REACH, JURISDICTIONAL BOUNDARIES, AND LIABILITY SHIELDS

2.1 Geographic Service Footprint

Trustora facilitates workforce deployment and EoR support across domestic and international markets. Delivering services across global boundaries does not mean or imply that Trustora maintains a physical legal entity, corporate branch, or direct employment license in every non-domestic operational territory.

2.2 Local Partner Network

Where Trustora delivers EoR services outside the Islamic Republic of Pakistan, it does so strictly on the basis of written engagement contracts and, where legally mandated, through qualified, licensed local statutory partners. Trustora does not hold itself out as a direct licensed employer in any foreign jurisdiction where it maintains no formal legal corporate entity registration.

2.3 Legal Separation of Supervision vs. Employment

In all EoR engagements, a clear legal distinction is maintained between operational direction and statutory employment:

- **Operational Direction:** The client retains sole responsibility for directing the day-to-day work, tasks, project deadlines, technical deliverables, and operational supervision of the assigned employee.
- **Statutory Employment:** Trustora acts strictly as the legal employer for administrative, payroll, tax, and statutory benefit compliance purposes.

2.4 Employer Liability Shield and Client Indemnification

To protect Trustora from third-party operational risks, all client Master Services Agreements (MSAs) must stipulate that:

- Trustora is not liable for operational errors, commercial losses, intellectual property infringement, code defects, or civil misdeeds committed by assigned employees while executing client-directed tasks.
- Clients must maintain comprehensive commercial general liability, professional indemnity, and cybersecurity insurance covering assigned EoR personnel.

- Clients agree to fully indemnify and hold harmless Trustora against any legal claims, liabilities, or losses arising from the client's workplace environment or operational directions.

3. POLICY HIERARCHY, APPLICABILITY, AND AMENDMENT GOVERNANCE

3.1 Scope of Policy Coverage

This policy applies universally to:

- All permanent, temporary, and executive officers directly employed by Trustora.
- All personnel employed by Trustora under Employer of Record (EoR) arrangements for client placements.
- All third-party consultants, independent contractors, and vendors engaged by Trustora.

3.2 Order of Precedence

In the event of an unavoidable conflict between the provisions of this policy document, local labor laws, executed client service contracts, or individualized employment offer letters, the strict order of legal precedence shall be:

1. Mandatory Federal and Provincial Legislation of Pakistan (or non-waivable statutory labor laws of the local employment jurisdiction).
2. Executed Individual Employment Contracts and Offer Letters.
3. Executed Client Master Services Agreements (MSA) and Service Level Agreements (SLA).
4. Trustora Corporate Operations Policy Document.

3.3 Unilateral Amendment Rights

Trustora reserves the exclusive right to update, modify, expand, or revise any section of this policy at its sole discretion to reflect changes in legal requirements, business operations, or risk management protocols. Updated versions will be published on trustora.net and become effective immediately upon posting.

4. EQUAL EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITY (EEO) AND NON-DISCRIMINATION

4.1 Meritocratic Principles

Trustora is an Equal Opportunity Employer. We are committed to fostering a fair, inclusive, and merit-based professional environment. All employment decisions—including recruitment, hiring, performance evaluation, compensation, promotion, training, discipline, and termination—are based strictly on candidate qualifications, documented job performance, and legitimate operational needs.

4.2 Protected Characteristics

Trustora strictly prohibits discrimination or harassment against any employee or applicant based on race, color, caste, national origin, ethnic origin, religion, creed, sex, gender, age, marital status, pregnancy, physical or mental disability, or any other status protected under applicable federal or provincial laws.

4.3 Reasonable Workplace Accommodations

Trustora provides reasonable workplace accommodations to qualified individuals with documented disabilities, provided such accommodations do not impose an undue operational or financial burden on the Company or its clients. Accommodation requests must be submitted in writing to info@trustora.net.

5. WORKPLACE HARASSMENT, BULLYING, AND DIGNITY AT WORK

5.1 Statutory Anti-Harassment Compliance

Trustora enforces a zero-tolerance policy regarding workplace harassment, sexual harassment, bullying, and intimidation, fully complying with the **Protection Against Harassment of Women at the Workplace Act, 2010** (and its provincial amendments).

5.2 Prohibited Conduct

Prohibited conduct includes, but is not limited to:

- Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or sexually suggestive comments or physical contact.
- Verbal abuse, derogatory slurs, hostile epithets, or offensive jokes targeting protected characteristics.
- Creating an intimidating, hostile, or degrading work environment through visual, verbal, or digital media.
- Workplace bullying, intentional professional isolation, unreasonable workload dumping, or public humiliation.

5.3 Inquiry Committee & Investigation Protocol

Trustora maintains a standing internal Inquiry Committee to investigate formal complaints of harassment or bullying:

- **Reporting:** Any employee who experiences or witnesses prohibited conduct must report the incident immediately in writing to info@trustora.net.

- **Investigation:** The Inquiry Committee will initiate a fair, confidential, and thorough investigation within three (3) business days of receiving the report. Both complainant and respondent will be provided an opportunity to present evidence and witness statements.
- **Final Action:** If a violation is substantiated, Trustora will impose immediate disciplinary measures, up to and including summary dismissal for cause and legal referral.

5.4 Prohibition of Retaliation

Retaliation against any individual who submits a harassment complaint in good faith, or who assists in an ongoing investigation, is strictly prohibited. Any act of proven retaliation will result in immediate termination of employment.

6. CODE OF CONDUCT, ETHICS, AND ANTI-BRIBERY CONTROLS

6.1 Standard of Integrity

All Trustora personnel and assigned EoR staff must conduct business with the highest standards of honesty, integrity, transparency, and professional decorum. Employees must avoid any action that could damage the business reputation or legal standing of Trustora or its clients.

6.2 Anti-Bribery and Corruption

In compliance with the Prevention of Corruption Act, the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA), and the UK Bribery Act standards:

- No employee, representative, or contractor acting on behalf of Trustora may directly or indirectly offer, pay, solicit, or accept any bribe, kickback, unlawful rebate, or facilitation payment to or from any public official, private client, or business counterparty.

- Any request for an improper payment or financial bribe made to a Trustora employee must be reported immediately to info@trustora.net.

6.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid any financial, professional, or personal activity that creates an actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest with Trustora or its clients. Secondary employment, consulting engagements, or personal commercial involvement with competitors or clients without prior written authorization from Trustora executive management is strictly prohibited.

6.4 Corporate Gifts and Hospitality

Employees may not accept gifts, entertainment, or hospitality from clients, suppliers, or third parties that exceed a nominal value of PKR 10,000 (or equivalent USD \$35). Any gift exceeding this threshold must be disclosed and approved via info@trustora.net.

7. GLOBAL SANCTIONS, ANTI-MONEY LAUNDERING (AML), AND INTEGRITY SCREENING

7.1 Mandatory Sanctions Screening

Trustora strictly complies with international trade controls, economic sanctions, and anti-money laundering (AML) laws. Prior to onboarding any client, vendor, internal employee, or assigned EoR candidate, Trustora executes automated background checks against restricted-party lists, including:

- United Nations Security Council (UNSC) Consolidated Sanctions List.
- United States Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) Specially Designated Nationals (SDN) List.
- UK HM Treasury Consolidated List of Financial Sanctions Targets.

- European Union Consolidated Financial Sanctions List.

7.2 Ongoing Automated Monitoring

All active client entities, beneficial owners, and employed personnel are re-screened on a scheduled basis against updated global sanctions databases.

7.3 Immediate Contract Termination Trigger

If a candidate, employee, client, or beneficial owner appears as a confirmed match on any global sanctions or restricted-party list, Trustora will immediately suspend all engagement terms, freeze payroll processing, block platform access, and notify relevant regulatory authorities as required by law.

8. COMPREHENSIVE MULTI-TIER BACKGROUND VERIFICATION FRAMEWORK

8.1 Mandatory Pre-Onboarding Screening

To mitigate operational risk and maintain compliance standards, all employment offers are strictly contingent upon the satisfactory completion of Trustora's comprehensive background verification process prior to active deployment.

8.2 Background Verification Categories

Candidates must complete and clear all mandatory verification categories detailed in the table below:

Verification Category	Required Documentation & Verification Mechanism	Legal & Compliance Baseline
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1. Identity Verification	Submission of valid NADRA Computerized National Identity Card (CNIC) for domestic staff, or valid International Passport for foreign personnel. Direct NADRA Verisys biometric validation.	Verifies legal identity, age, and citizenship baseline.
2. Family Background Verification	Mandatory submission of the standardized Trustora Family Background Verification Form (hosted on Trustora's official GitHub repository), capturing parental details, spouse/dependents, and complete sibling breakdown.	Establishes identity history and compliance with Pakistani labor standards.
3. Criminal Record Check	Submission of an official Police Character Certificate / Police Clearance issued by the Capital City Police Office or local police station covering all residential addresses from the prior 5 years.	Verifies clean criminal record; disqualifies candidates with convictions for fraud, violence, or theft.
4. Educational Credentials	Official degree certificates and transcripts. Verification of highest qualification through the Higher Education Commission (HEC) of Pakistan or foreign equivalent.	Authenticates academic qualifications and professional licenses.
5. Prior Employment History	Direct written reference checks and telephone calls with HR/Management covering a minimum 3- to 5-year tenure history.	Confirms previous job titles, employment dates, conduct, and reasons for departure.

8.3 Misrepresentation Penalties

Falsification, misrepresentation, or intentional omission of material facts on any application document or the Family Background Verification Form constitutes grounds for immediate disqualification of candidature or summary termination of employment without notice or severance pay.

9. MANDATORY DRUG-FREE WORKPLACE AND SUBSTANCE TESTING POLICY

9.1 Zero Tolerance Standard

Trustora maintains a strict **Drug-Free Workplace Policy**. The unlawful manufacture, distribution, dispensation, possession, sale, or use of illegal drugs, illicit narcotics, unprescribed controlled substances, or alcohol in any company office, client site, or remote working environment is strictly prohibited.

9.2 Mandatory Pre-Employment Drug Testing

Candidates selected for technical, client-facing, security-sensitive, management, or EoR placement roles must successfully undergo and pass a standard 5-panel or 10-panel drug test at a Trustora-approved medical diagnostic laboratory before contract finalization. Testing screens for substances including amphetamines, cannabis/THC, cocaine, opiates, phencyclidine, and benzodiazepines.

9.3 Reasonable Suspicion and Post-Incident Testing

Trustora reserves the absolute right to mandate immediate medical drug or alcohol screening under the following circumstances:

- **Reasonable Suspicion:** Where an employee exhibits visible physical impairment, slurred speech, erratic behavioral changes, or compromised performance on duty.

- **Post-Incident Testing:** Following any workplace accident, physical altercation, safety violation, or property damage event occurring during working hours.

9.4 Testing Chain of Custody

Medical testing will be conducted by certified diagnostic partners under strict chain-of-custody protocols to ensure sample integrity and medical confidentiality.

9.5 Disciplinary Consequences

- Refusal to submit to a mandatory drug screen within the requested timeframe will be treated as an admission of non-compliance and will result in immediate termination.
- Tampering with, diluting, or substituting a test sample will result in summary dismissal for cause.
- A confirmed positive test result for illegal narcotics or unauthorized controlled substances will result in immediate termination of employment for cause, without notice or severance pay.

10. PRE-EMPLOYMENT CONDITIONS, OFFER LETTERS, AND CONTRACT FORMALIZATION

10.1 Conditions Precedent

No employment contract is binding upon Trustora until all pre-employment conditions precedent are fully satisfied, including:

- Receipt of satisfactory background verification results across all 5 verification categories.

- Receipt of a clean pre-employment drug testing result from an approved laboratory.
- Satisfactory verification of professional credentials and right-to-work documentation.

10.2 Mandatory Employment Terms

Every employment relationship must be formalized in writing through an Offer Letter and Employment Contract, executed by an authorized executive of Trustora prior to the start of work. Contracts must explicitly state:

- Detailed job description, duty expectations, and reporting lines.
- Salary breakdown: Basic Salary and itemized Fixed Allowances.
- Work location (Physical Office or Remote Work status).
- Working hours, probationary period terms, and notice period obligations.
- Statutory leave entitlements and benefits.
- Express agreement to abide by all Trustora corporate policies.

10.3 Entire Agreement Clause

The executed written employment contract constitutes the entire agreement between Trustora and the employee. Verbal promises, informal email exchanges, or representations not explicitly incorporated into the executed written contract are void and unenforceable.

11. COMPENSATION STRUCTURE AND STATUTORY TAX WITHHOLDING

11.1 Salary Structure Composition

To ensure legal compliance with Pakistani statutory frameworks, employee compensation is structured into Basic Salary and itemized allowances:

- **Basic Salary:** Forms the statutory foundation for computing retirement benefits, gratuity, and severance pay (typically representing 50% to 60% of gross salary).
- **Fixed Allowances:** Itemized allocations including House Rent Allowance, Utility Allowance, and Medical Allowance, structured in accordance with local taxation norms and client requirements.

11.2 Mandatory Income Tax Withholding (FBR)

Trustora calculates and withholds individual income tax at source from monthly payroll disbursements in accordance with the prevailing progressive tax slabs enacted under the **Income Tax Ordinance, 2001** (Federal Board of Revenue, Pakistan).

11.3 Tax Deduction Certificates

Trustora remits all withheld income taxes directly to the national exchequer under its corporate NTN. Annual tax deduction certificates (Form IT-3) are issued to employees following the end of each tax year (June 30th) via info@trustora.net.

12. PAYROLL PROCESSING CYCLES, CURRENCY CONTROLS, AND CASH FLOW GOVERNANCE

12.1 Semi-Monthly Payroll Schedule

Payroll is processed on a strict twice-monthly operational cycle:

- **Cycle 1:** Disbursed on the **Second Friday** of each calendar month (covering the first half-month pay period).

- **Cycle 2:** Disbursed on the **Fourth Friday** of each calendar month (covering the second half-month pay period).

If a scheduled pay date falls on a bank holiday or weekend, funds will be released on the immediately preceding business day.

12.2 Payment Currency and Foreign Exchange Risk

Salaries for personnel residing and working in Pakistan are denominated and paid exclusively in Pakistan Rupees (PKR) through direct bank transfer to verified individual bank accounts. Where client contracts are billed in foreign currency (e.g., USD, EUR, GBP), foreign exchange conversion rates are locked at the invoice generation point or managed via explicit currency fluctuation clauses in the client MSA.

12.3 Pre-Funded Invoice Cash Flow Model

Trustora operates payroll on a pre-funded invoice model to safeguard corporate capital:

1. Trustora issues a monthly pre-payroll invoice to the client covering gross employment costs, statutory contributions, and EoR management fees.
2. The client must settle the invoice via bank wire transfer prior to the scheduled payroll execution date.
3. Trustora releases salary disbursements to assigned personnel only upon receipt and clearance of client pre-funding. Trustora reserves the right to suspend payroll execution if client funding is delayed.

13. STATUTORY RETIREMENT AND END-OF-SERVICE BENEFITS (GRATUITY & PROVIDENT FUND)

13.1 Framework and Applicability

Trustora ensures complete compliance with statutory end-of-service benefits under the **West Pakistan Industrial and Commercial Employment (Standing Orders) Ordinance, 1968** and applicable provincial labor amendments.

13.2 Statutory Gratuity Scheme

- **Eligibility:** All permanent employees who complete twelve (12) consecutive months of continuous service with Trustora are legally entitled to statutory gratuity upon termination, resignation, retirement, death, or total disablement.
- **Calculation Rate:** Gratuity is calculated at the rate of **thirty (30) days' basic salary** for every completed year of service, or any part thereof in excess of six (6) months.
- **Wage Base:** The calculation is based on the last basic salary drawn by the employee prior to leaving service.
- **Forfeiture Conditions:** Statutory gratuity may be forfeited, in whole or in part, if an employee's services are terminated for proven gross misconduct, theft, fraud, arson, or deliberate destruction of company or client property.

13.3 Approved Provident Fund Scheme

Where Trustora or a participating client establishes an Approved Provident Fund in lieu of a gratuity scheme:

- **Contributions:** Equal monthly contributions (a minimum of 10% of basic salary) are deducted from the employee's salary and matched equally by Trustora/Client.
- **Trust Management:** Provident Fund capital is managed by an independent Board of Trustees and invested strictly in accordance with the provisions of the Companies Act, 2017 and the Income Tax Rules, 2002.
- **Vesting Schedule:** Employee contributions and accumulated interest vest immediately. Employer matching contributions vest fully upon completion of two (2) years of continuous service.

13.4 Non-Duplication Principle

Employees shall be entitled to receive either Statutory Gratuity or the Provident Fund employer match, whichever yields the greater financial benefit or is designated under the specific terms of their employment contract, but never both, unless explicitly mandated by statutory local law.

14. EMPLOYEES' OLD-AGE BENEFITS INSTITUTION (EOBI) AND PROVINCIAL SOCIAL SECURITY (SESSI / PESSI / IESSI)

14.1 EOBI Federal Pension Compliance

- **Mandatory Registration:** In compliance with the **Employees' Old-Age Benefits Act, 1976**, Trustora registers all eligible employees with the EOBI federal system.
- **Contribution Breakdown:** Trustora remits monthly contributions consisting of:
 - o **Employer Contribution:** 5% of the statutory minimum wage rate.
 - o **Employee Contribution:** 1% of the statutory minimum wage rate (deducted at source from employee monthly payroll).
- **Entitlements:** Covered employees qualify for statutory invalidity pensions, old-age pensions, survivor pensions, and old-age grants directly administered by EOBI.

14.2 Provincial Social Security Coverage (SESSI / PESSI / IESSI)

- **Registration & Contributions:** Trustora complies with provincial social security laws (including the Sindh Employees' Social Security Institution - SESSI, Punjab Employees' Social Security Institution - PESSI, and Islamabad Employees' Social Security Institution - IESSI) by contributing 6% of the applicable wage limit per covered employee.

- **Benefits Package:** Registered personnel receive access to provincial medical care facilities, sickness allowances, maternity benefits, disability pensions, and death grants.

14.3 Corporate Guarantee & Compliance Audits

Trustora maintains dedicated statutory registers and guarantees prompt monthly contribution payments. All EOBI and Social Security contribution cards and registration numbers are issued to employees upon processing by statutory authorities. Inquiries or requests for contribution receipts must be directed to info@trustora.net.

15. ANNUAL, CASUAL, AND MEDICAL LEAVE GOVERNANCE

15.1 Statutory Annual / Earned Leave

- **Accrual & Entitlement:** Employees completing twelve (12) months of continuous service accrue **fourteen (14) consecutive calendar days** of fully paid Annual Leave.
- **Scheduling & Notice:** Annual Leave must be requested at least fourteen (14) days in advance via info@trustora.net and requires approval from both Trustora management and the assigned client supervisor.
- **Accumulation & Encashment:** Unutilized Annual Leave may be carried forward for up to one (1) year, subject to a maximum cap of 14 days, or encashed at the time of final settlement upon separation of service based on basic salary.

15.2 Casual Leave

- **Entitlement:** Employees receive **ten (10) days** of fully paid Casual Leave per calendar year.

- **Purpose:** Intended to handle unforeseen personal emergencies, urgent domestic matters, or sudden family obligations.
- **Restrictions:** Casual Leave cannot be taken for more than three (3) consecutive days at a time, cannot be combined with Annual Leave, cannot be carried forward to the next calendar year, and is non-encashable.

15.3 Medical / Sick Leave

- **Entitlement:** Employees are entitled to up to **sixteen (16) days** of Sick Leave per calendar year (eight days at full pay and eight days at half pay, or sixteen days at full pay as per applicable provincial Standing Orders).
- **Medical Certification Requirement:** For any sick leave absence extending beyond two (2) consecutive working days, the employee must submit an official medical certificate signed by a licensed medical practitioner (registered with PMDC/PMC) to info@trustora.net within 48 hours of absence.
- **Fitness-for-Duty Clearance:** Trustora reserves the right to require an independent medical examination or fitness-for-duty clearance before an employee returns from extended sick leave exceeding seven (7) consecutive days.

16. STATUTORY MATERNITY AND PATERNITY LEAVE ENTITLEMENTS

16.1 Governing Legal Framework

Trustora strictly enforces leave rights under the **Maternity and Paternity Leave Act, 2023** and applicable provincial maternity protection statutes.

16.2 Maternity Leave Rights for Female Employees

Female employees are entitled to fully paid Maternity Leave outside their regular accrued leave balances as follows:

- **First Child:** Up to **180 calendar days** of fully paid maternity leave.
- **Second Child:** Up to **120 calendar days** of fully paid maternity leave.
- **Third Child:** Up to **90 calendar days** of fully paid maternity leave.

Notice & Protection: Written notice along with medical documentation stating the expected date of delivery must be submitted to info@trustora.net at least thirty (30) days prior to the intended leave start date. It is illegal to terminate a female employee while she is on approved statutory maternity leave.

16.3 Paternity Leave Rights for Male Employees

Male employees are entitled to fully paid Paternity Leave of up to **thirty (30) calendar days** outside regular leave balances, applicable for up to three (3) occurrences across their total employment tenure with Trustora. Paternity leave must be utilized within the period immediately preceding or following the birth of the child.

17. OFFICIAL GAZETTED PUBLIC HOLIDAYS AND RELIGIOUS ACCOMMODATIONS

17.1 National Public Holidays

Trustora observes all official public holidays gazetted annually by the Ministry of Interior, Government of Pakistan. Employees are granted fully paid time off on the following designated national occasions:

- **Kashmir Solidarity Day:** February 5
- **Pakistan Day:** March 23
- **Labour Day:** May 1

- **Independence Day:** August 14
- **Allama Iqbal Day:** November 9
- **Quaid-e-Azam Day & Christmas:** December 25
- **Eid-ul-Fitr:** 3 official gazetted days (lunar calendar)
- **Eid-ul-Adha:** 3 official gazetted days (lunar calendar)
- **Ashura (9th & 10th Muharram):** 2 official gazetted days (lunar calendar)
- **Eid Milad-un-Nabi (12th Rabi-ul-Awwal):** 1 official gazetted day (lunar calendar)

17.2 Lunar Holiday Adjustments

Official dates for Islamic lunar holidays are governed by notifications issued by the Central Ruet-e-Hilal Committee or Federal Government.

17.3 Optional Religious Holiday Accommodation

Non-Muslim staff members are entitled to up to **three (3) optional paid religious holidays** per calendar year to celebrate major religious festivals (e.g., Easter, Holi, Diwali, Good Friday) by providing at least seven (7) days' advance written notice to info@trustora.net.

17.4 Holiday Overtime and Shift Coverage

If an employee assigned to an international client is required to perform work on an official Pakistani gazetted holiday due to client operational mandates, the employee will be provided compensatory time off or holiday premium pay as stipulated in their employment agreement.

18. PROBATIONARY EVALUATION AND PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

18.1 Probationary Period Duration

All newly hired internal staff and client-assigned EoR personnel undergo a standard **six (6) month probationary period** starting from their official date of joining.

18.2 Evaluation Milestones

- **3-Month Midterm Review:** An informal performance check conducted by management/client to assess initial integration, technical output, and cultural fit.
- **5-Month Final Evaluation:** A formal performance review assessing key performance indicators (KPIs), attendance, technical proficiency, and professional conduct.

18.3 Probation Extension or Termination

- **Termination During Probation:** Either party may terminate the employment relationship during the probationary period by issuing **fourteen (14) days' written notice** or paying basic salary in lieu of notice.
- **Extension:** If an employee's performance is unsatisfactory but demonstrates potential for improvement, Trustora reserves the right to extend the probationary period by an additional period not exceeding three (3) months.

18.4 Confirmation Protocol

Employment status remains probationary until Trustora issues an official written Confirmation Letter. Confirmation is never automatic upon the passage of time.

19. CONTRACT TERMINATION, SEVERANCE, AND OFFBOARDING PROTOCOLS

19.1 Termination Without Cause (Post-Confirmation)

Following confirmation of permanent status, either Trustora or the employee may terminate the employment contract without stating cause by serving **thirty (30) days' advance written notice** or by paying **thirty (30) days' basic salary** in lieu of notice.

19.2 Summary Dismissal For Cause (Immediate Termination)

Trustora reserves the right to terminate employment immediately, without notice, notice pay, or severance benefits, if an employee commits gross misconduct, including but not limited to:

- Proven dishonesty, embezzlement, fraud, bribery, or theft.
- Physical violence, threats, or severe harassment in the workplace.
- Serious breach of client confidentiality or intellectual property theft.
- Habitual absence without leave for more than ten (10) consecutive business days.
- Confirmed positive test result for illegal narcotics or unauthorized controlled substances.
- Criminal conviction by a court of law involving moral turpitude.

19.3 Complete Asset Return and Offboarding Clearance

Upon notice of termination or resignation, the employee must immediately initiate offboarding procedures:

- **Asset Handover:** All company/client property—including laptops, mobile devices, security keycards, physical documents, and software access tokens—must be returned in good working condition within forty-eight (48) hours of notice.
- **System Revocation:** Operational credentials, remote desktop access, and corporate email access will be terminated on the final working day (or immediately in cases of dismissal for cause).

19.4 Final Settlement Processing

Final financial settlements—including unpaid salary, accrued annual leave encashment, statutory gratuity, and expense reimbursements—will be calculated and disbursed within thirty (30) calendar days following the last working day, contingent upon receipt of a signed Asset Handover & Offboarding Clearance Form.

20. PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION AND PRIVACY RIGHTS (PDPA / GDPR)

20.1 Regulatory Data Privacy Standards

Trustora collects, stores, processes, and transfers personal data in compliance with the **Pakistan Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA)** guidelines, international privacy frameworks, and **General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)** principles where cross-border data flows occur.

20.2 Categories of Personal Data Processed

Trustora processes candidate and employee Personally Identifiable Information (PII) solely for employment administration, payroll, background checks, tax filing, and statutory compliance. Data categories include:

- Legal name, CNIC number, passport details, residential address, contact details.

- Bank account details, salary history, tax identification numbers.
- Educational credentials, criminal background clearance certificates, reference letters.
- Mandatory Family Background Verification Forms (containing parental, spouse, and sibling information).
- Medical diagnostic reports (including drug testing certificates).

20.3 Data Security and Storage Controls

All physical personnel files are maintained in locked, access-controlled document archives. Digital records are encrypted at rest and in transit using industry-standard AES-256 encryption within secure, access-restricted cloud infrastructure.

20.4 Data Subject Rights and Contact

Employees have the right to inspect, correct, or request the update of their personal data. Requests regarding data protection, privacy inquiries, or data erasure requests (where statutory retention periods have expired) must be submitted directly to info@trustora.net.

21. INFORMATION SECURITY, DEVICE CONTROLS, AND GENERATIVE AI POLICY

21.1 Technical Information Security Baseline

All employees operating corporate or client-assigned computer hardware, network assets, or software infrastructure must strictly adhere to the following technical controls:

- **Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** MFA must be enabled across all corporate email accounts, cloud repositories, code platforms, and software portals.

- **Full-Disk Encryption:** Mandatory activation of BitLocker (Windows) or FileVault (macOS) full-disk encryption on all laptops or desktops handling company or client data.
- **Password Hygiene:** Utilization of complex passwords (minimum 14 characters) and mandatory updates every 90 days. Sharing passwords or access credentials is strictly forbidden.

21.2 Hardware Usage and Physical Security

- Laptops and mobile devices must never be left unattended in public spaces or unsecured vehicles.
- Employees are strictly prohibited from installing unauthorized, unlicensed, or peer-to-peer (P2P) software on company/client hardware.

21.3 Mandatory Policy on Commercial Generative AI Tools

To protect client intellectual property, corporate trade secrets, and regulatory data privacy:

- **Strict Prohibition:** Employees are strictly prohibited from pasting, uploading, submitting, or feeding proprietary source code, client PII, confidential contracts, internal financial metrics, or customer datasets into unapproved commercial, public, or free Generative AI platforms (including, but not limited to, public ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or third-party web AI plugins).
- **Authorized AI Deployments:** Generative AI tools may only be utilized if explicitly authorized by client engineering management in writing, or deployed via isolated, offline local LLM environments (e.g., local Ollama deployments) or dedicated enterprise-grade tenants with guaranteed non-training data privacy clauses.
- **Disciplinary Action:** Unauthorized input of proprietary software code or confidential client data into commercial AI tools will be treated as a severe security

breach, resulting in immediate disciplinary action up to summary dismissal for cause and potential legal prosecution.

22. REMOTE WORK GOVERNANCE AND PHYSICAL/CYBER HYGIENE

22.1 Remote Work Workstation Standards

Employees approved for remote work arrangements must maintain a dedicated, clean, quiet, and physically secure workstation environment:

- **Physical Confidentiality:** Remote workstations must be positioned to prevent unauthorized viewing of sensitive client data by family members, guests, or the public (shoulder surfing protection).
- **Clean Desk Policy:** Sensitive physical files and corporate documents must be locked away when the employee is away from their desk.

22.2 Network and Connection Security

- Remote employees must connect to the internet via secured, password-protected private home networks or corporate Virtual Private Networks (VPNs).
- The use of open, unencrypted public Wi-Fi networks (e.g., in coffee shops, airports, or hotels) for conducting company business is strictly prohibited unless an approved corporate VPN is active.

22.3 Operational Hours and SLA Compliance

Remote employees must remain reachable via official communication platforms (e.g., Slack, Microsoft Teams, email) during agreed client core operational hours and respond to urgent operational queries within established Service Level Agreements (SLAs).

23. OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH, SAFETY, AND ENVIRONMENTAL STANDARDS

23.1 Duty of Care

Trustora is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and ergonomically sound working environment for all employees across physical corporate offices and supporting safe home-office practices for remote personnel.

23.2 Emergency Procedures

Employees working at physical facilities must familiarize themselves with emergency evacuation routes, fire extinguisher locations, and first-aid station points.

23.3 Incident Reporting Mandate

Any workplace accident, occupational injury, physical security breach, or hazardous condition occurring during working hours—whether at a client site, corporate office, or remote workspace—must be reported within **twenty-four (24) hours** to info@trustora.net.

24. SECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE AND DATA BREACH MANAGEMENT

24.1 Incident Definition

A security incident or data breach includes any confirmed or suspected event involving unauthorized access, loss, theft, compromise, or exposure of confidential business data, client intellectual property, system credentials, or employee PII.

24.2 Mandatory Escalation Protocol

In the event of a lost/stolen device, suspected phishing breach, malware infection, or data leak, the employee must immediately report the details within **twenty-four (24) hours** (or sooner) to info@trustora.net.

24.3 Incident Containment and Investigation

Upon notification:

1. Trustora IT and Security personnel will execute immediate technical containment protocols (remote device wipe, credential revocation, session termination).
2. A formal forensic investigation will be conducted to assess the scope and impact of the incident.
3. Trustora will issue notifications to impacted clients, regulatory authorities (e.g., SECP, FBR, Data Protection Commissioners), and affected individuals as mandated by law and MSA covenants.

25. GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL AND WHISTLEBLOWER PROTECTIONS

25.1 Internal Grievance Resolution

Trustora maintains a fair, transparent procedure for resolving employee grievances regarding working conditions, payroll discrepancies, managerial treatment, or peer conflicts:

- **Step 1:** Submit a formal written statement of grievance to info@trustora.net.
- **Step 2:** Management will schedule a confidential hearing within five (5) business days of submission.
- **Step 3:** A written decision and corrective action plan will be issued to the employee within ten (10) business days following the hearing.

25.2 Whistleblower Protection Policy

Employees are encouraged to report any known or suspected unlawful conduct, financial fraud, tax evasion, illegal bribery, regulatory non-compliance, or severe safety violations occurring within Trustora or client operations:

- **Confidential Reporting:** Disclosures may be submitted confidentially to info@trustora.net.
- **Protection Against Retaliation:** Trustora guarantees that no employee who files a whistleblower report in good faith will suffer discharge, demotion, suspension, harassment, or professional retaliation.
- **Malicious Allegations:** Intentionally making false or malicious allegations will result in disciplinary action.

26. CORPORATE GOVERNANCE, POLICY REVIEW, AND ADMINISTRATION

26.1 Policy Ownership and Annual Audit

This policy document represents the official Employer of Record (EoR) Operations & Corporate Governance Policy of TRUSTORA (SMC-PRIVATE) LIMITED. It is owned by Executive Management and is subjected to formal review annually or immediately following significant federal/provincial statutory law updates.

26.2 Binding Authority and Publication

This policy document is published on the official web portal at trustora.net. Continued employment with Trustora constitutes full acceptance of and agreement to comply with all provisions contained within this policy document.

26.3 Official Central Contact Channel

All formal notices, legal inquiries, background verification forms, leave requests, grievance filings, data privacy requests, and compliance disclosures must be submitted exclusively through the single official corporate contact email:

- **Official Corporate Contact Email:** info@trustora.net

Here is the updated **Section 27** for your policy document, fully incorporating the detailed explanation and breakdown of the **SMART** methodology for check-ins and check-outs:

27. STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP AND WORKFORCE TRACKING GOVERNANCE (FOCUS HIVE & FOCUS TRACKER)

27.1 Strategic Partnership with Focus Hive

Trustora maintains a formal strategic partnership with **Focus Hive** to optimize workforce performance, project tracking, and deliverable execution. Under this framework, Trustora deploys Focus Hive's proprietary performance management platform, **Focus Tracker**, across all operational units and client-assigned Employer of Record (EoR) personnel.

27.2 Mandatory Utilization of Focus Tracker

To ensure progress transparency, objective accountability, and metric-driven performance evaluations, all employees must actively utilize Focus Tracker throughout their working hours. The platform monitors active work streams and calculates quantitative progress against daily targets and project deliverables.

27.3 Focus Shift Architecture for Full-Time Employees

Daily operational schedules for full-time personnel are structured around standard four (4) hour work units designated as **Focus Shifts**. Full-time employees are required to

complete two (2) Focus Shifts per standard working day according to the following protocol:

- **First Focus Shift (4 Hours):** Employees must execute a **SMART In** protocol on Focus Tracker at the start of their shift and execute a **SMART Out** protocol upon completing the first four-hour block.
- **Mandatory Operational Break:** Following the completion of the first Focus Shift, employees must take a compulsory **one (1) hour break**.
- **Second Focus Shift (4 Hours):** Upon returning from the break, employees must execute a **SMART In** protocol to begin the second four-hour block and execute a **SMART Out** protocol upon completing the shift.

27.4 Definition and Protocol for "SMART In" and "SMART Out"

The terms **SMART In** and **SMART Out** refer to structured, deliverable-driven check-in and check-out procedures integrated into Focus Tracker. In this context, **SMART** stands for:

- **S – Specific:** Clear definition of the precise tasks and scope to be executed during the Focus Shift.
- **M – Measurable:** Quantifiable targets or output metrics assigned to the shift's workload.
- **A – Achievable:** Realistic operational targets planned strictly for execution within the 4-hour window.
- **R – Relevant:** Direct alignment of planned shift activities with core client or company milestones.
- **T – Time-bound:** Execution confined to the designated 4-hour Focus Shift duration.

SMART In Protocol (Shift Initiation)

At the start of every Focus Shift, the employee must perform a **SMART In** by logging into Focus Tracker, defining their specific SMART goals for that 4-hour block, and activating session tracking before initiating work.

SMART Out Protocol (Shift Conclusion)

At the end of every Focus Shift, the employee must perform a **SMART Out** by logging their completed deliverables, uploading required proof of work/progress metrics into Focus Tracker, and officially closing the session.

27.5 Automated Progress Calculation and Compliance

The Focus Tracker platform evaluates real-time productivity by comparing work logged during **SMART Out** against the initial commitments made during **SMART In**.

Failure to execute SMART In and SMART Out protocols, unauthorized gaps during active Focus Shifts, or consistently falling below required progress thresholds will be flagged automatically and reviewed under standard performance management and attendance compliance procedures.

28. ZERO TRUST CYBERSECURITY ARCHITECTURE AND GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORKS***28.1 Zero Trust Security Core Philosophy***

Trustora operates under a strict **Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA)** framework governed by the core principle: "**Never Trust, Always Verify.**" Under this model, physical location or network position—whether working inside a physical company office, connecting via a client network, or working remotely—confers zero implicit trust. Every access request to corporate systems, client environments, data repositories, or internal applications must be explicitly authenticated, authorized, and continuously validated before access is granted.

28.2 Recognized Security Framework Alignment

Trustora's cybersecurity operations, data defense policies, and access controls are aligned with international cybersecurity standards, specifically:

- **NIST SP 800-207:** National Institute of Standards and Technology Zero Trust Architecture guidelines.
- **ISO/IEC 27001:** Information Security Management System (ISMS) controls regarding access management, cryptography, and asset protection.

28.3 Pillar Implementation of Zero Trust Controls

Trustora enforces Zero Trust across five critical operational pillars:

1. Identity Verification & Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

- Identity serves as the primary security perimeter. Access to any company or client asset requires centralized Identity and Access Management (IAM) authentication.
- **Mandatory MFA:** Multi-Factor Authentication using secure authenticator applications (TOTP) or hardware security keys (FIDO2) is strictly mandatory across all corporate accounts, code repositories, cloud infrastructure, and client portals. SMS-based or unencrypted email-based verification methods are prohibited.

2. Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP) and Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

- Personnel are granted the absolute minimum level of system, network, and database access required to perform their specific job functions.
- Default access across all systems is set to "Deny All."
- Elevated administrative permissions are granted strictly on a **Just-In-Time (JIT)** basis, requiring explicit managerial approval and auto-expiring after the task is completed.

3. Device Health & Posture Assessment

- No device (laptop, desktop, or mobile) is permitted to interface with corporate or client data environments without passing automated endpoint posture checks.
- Device authorization requires active full-disk encryption (BitLocker/FileVault), updated Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) software, and fully patched operating systems.

4. Micro-Segmentation and Network Isolation

- Internal networks and cloud infrastructure are broken down into isolated micro-segments to prevent lateral movement of threats in the event of a breach.
- Access to one system or project environment does not provide implicit network access to adjacent services or client environments.

5. Continuous Session Telemetry and Real-Time Risk Scoring

- Authentication is not a one-time event at login. Focus Tracker, IAM platforms, and security agents continuously evaluate risk factors (e.g., unexpected IP location changes, concurrent logins, anomalous data transfer volumes).
- If suspicious activity or anomalous risk is detected, session tokens are automatically invalidated, requiring immediate re-authentication and security team notification.

28.4 Employee Compliance and Security Audits

Attempts to bypass Zero Trust security controls including disabling endpoint agents, attempting unauthorized privilege escalation, or utilizing unauthorized proxy servers/VPNs constitute severe security violations resulting in immediate account suspension, formal investigation, and potential termination for cause.

Here is **Section 29** formatted in the exact corporate structure and legal tone of your existing policy document, ready to copy and paste:

29. AGILE CEREMONIES, MEETING ETIQUETTE, AND COMMUNICATION STANDARDS

29.1 Mandatory Attendance in Agile and Scrum Ceremonies

To maintain seamless cross-functional alignment, transparent project delivery, and continuous feedback loops, active participation in all team-level Agile and Scrum ceremonies is mandatory. All internal staff and client-assigned Employer of Record (EoR) personnel must punctually attend all scheduled meetings, including:

- Daily Standups / Daily Scrum
- Sprint Planning Meetings
- Backlog Refinement / Grooming Sessions
- Sprint Reviews and Client Demonstrations
- Sprint Retrospectives

Unexcused absences, habitual tardiness, or leaving ceremonies prematurely without prior authorization from the Scrum Master, Engineering Lead, or Client Supervisor constitutes non-compliance and will directly impact shift evaluations and performance metrics.

29.2 Mandatory "Camera-On" Video Standard

To ensure professional engagement, active collaboration, and team cohesion across hybrid and remote environments, employees are subject to a mandatory **Camera-On Policy**:

- **Hardware Requirement:** Every employee must maintain a working, high-definition webcam or integrated camera setup.

- **Continuous Active Stream:** Video feeds must remain powered on, unblocked, and active throughout the entire duration of every Agile meeting.
- **Professional Visual Hygiene:** Employees must ensure adequate lighting, professional attire, and a clean, non-distracting physical workspace or an approved neutral virtual background.

29.3 Audio Quality and Microphone Hardware Standards

Clear vocal communication is essential for efficient technical discussions and client interactions. Employees must maintain proper audio infrastructure complying with the following standards:

- **Audio Equipment:** Employees must utilize a dedicated headset or specialized external microphone configured to suppress ambient background noise and room echo.
- **Microphone Positioning:** To achieve optimal acoustic clarity and prevent audio clipping, distortion, or breathing noise, microphones must be positioned approximately **six (6) inches from the employee's mouth**.
- **Audio Testing:** Employees must verify their audio input/output settings prior to joining any scheduled meeting to avoid technical delays or disruption.

29.4 Meeting Environment and Noise Control

All Agile meetings must be conducted from a quiet, private, and secure location. Joining team ceremonies from high-noise environments (e.g., public places, transit, busy outdoor areas, or spaces with intrusive domestic background noise) is strictly prohibited.

29.5 Technical Fault Reporting and Compliance

If an employee experiences an unexpected hardware failure (e.g., camera malfunction, microphone damage, or internet connectivity outage) immediately prior to or during an Agile ceremony:

1. The employee must immediately notify the meeting host and team lead via the official team communication channel (e.g., Slack or Microsoft Teams).
2. The issue must be reported to info@trustora.net within two (2) hours of occurrence, along with a timeline for hardware repair or replacement.
3. Repeated, unverified claims of "technical difficulties" preventing camera or microphone usage will be formally investigated as attendance and policy compliance violations.

Here is **Section 30** formatted in the exact corporate structure and legal tone of your existing policy document, ready to copy and paste:

30. AGILE DASHBOARD MANAGEMENT, TASK TRANSPARENCY, AND DELIVERABLE TRACKING

30.1 Mandatory Agile Dashboard Maintenance

To maintain full operational visibility, rigorous deliverable tracking, and structured project governance, all internal staff and client-assigned Employer of Record (EoR) personnel must maintain an active, real-time Agile project management dashboard (e.g., GitHub Projects, Jira, or designated client board). Operating without an updated dashboard or performing untracked, undocumented work is strictly prohibited.

30.2 Milestone Alignment and Epic Structuring

Every task, sub-task, or backlog item assigned to an employee must be explicitly linked to a recognized corporate or client **Milestone** and **Epic**:

- **Milestone Mapping:** Employees are strictly required to verify that active work items directly map to defined, time-bound project milestones.
- **Scope Definition:** Tasks must feature clear acceptance criteria, technical dependencies, and defined target completion dates before work initiates.

30.3 Granular Task Logging and Time Allocation

Employees are required to maintain complete transparency across their active dashboard cards by logging the following mandatory data points in real time:

- **Current Status:** Immediate updating of task columns (e.g., *Backlog, To Do, In Progress, In Review, Completed*).
- **Time Allocation & Estimation:** Accurate logging of estimated effort versus actual time spent on each individual task.
- **Daily Updates & Blockers:** Regular written progress notes attached directly to active task cards, including immediate flagging of any technical blockers, external dependencies, or potential scope risks.

30.4 Integration of SMART In and SMART Out Protocols into Dashboard Tasks

To establish a direct audit trail between time tracking and actual technical output, employees must link their daily Focus Tracker sessions directly to specific task cards on their Agile dashboard:

- **Task-Level SMART In:** During the shift initiation (**SMART In**), the employee must attach the specific Agile task ID/card link to their Focus Tracker session, explicitly stating the target deliverable for that 4-hour Focus Shift.
- **Task-Level SMART Out:** Upon shift conclusion (**SMART Out**), the employee must post a summary update, proof of work (e.g., pull request link, commit hash, documentation draft, or design asset), and updated time logs directly onto the corresponding dashboard task card.

30.5 Compliance and Audit Governance

Project Leads, Scrum Masters, and Executive Management conduct daily dashboard audits to evaluate team velocity and deliverable integrity. Unrecorded work will not be recognized toward Focus Shift progress or deliverable completion metrics, and persistent failure to maintain dashboard transparency will result in formal performance management review.

A critical standard section for Employer of Record (EoR) companies covers **Intellectual Property (IP) Flow-Through, Work-for-Hire Guarantees, and Permanent Establishment (PE) Risk Mitigation**.

Here is **Section 31** formatted in the exact corporate structure and legal tone of your existing policy document, ready to copy and paste:

31. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (IP) FLOW-THROUGH, WORK-FOR-HIRE GUARANTEES, AND PERMANENT ESTABLISHMENT (PE) SHIELD

31.1 Comprehensive Work-for-Hire and Immediate IP Assignment

All works of authorship, software source code, algorithms, hardware designs, industrial processes, patents, trademarks, trade secrets, and technical documentation created, authored, developed, or reduced to practice by client-assigned Employer of Record (EoR) personnel during their employment with Trustora—whether individually or jointly—constitute "Works Made for Hire".

- **Automatic Assignment:** To the extent any intellectual property (IP) does not automatically qualify as a "Work Made for Hire" under applicable local legislation, the employee irrevocably assigns, transfers, and conveys all rights, title, interest, and moral rights in such IP to Trustora (and through Trustora, directly to the designated client entity) immediately upon creation.

- **Waiver of Moral Rights:** Employees irrevocably waive all moral rights, rights of attribution, and integrity claims under international copyright treaties regarding work products created during client assignments.

31.2 Execution of Direct IP Assignment Side-Agreements

Where required by local jurisdiction laws, foreign client jurisdictions, or explicit client Master Services Agreements (MSAs), assigned EoR personnel must execute direct Intellectual Property Assignment Agreements, Non-Disclosure Agreements (NDAs), and Proprietary Information and Inventions Agreements (PIIA) as a condition precedent to deployment.

31.3 Permanent Establishment (PE) Exposure Shield and Commercial Boundaries

To shield both Trustora and its client partners from unintended corporate tax liabilities, foreign registration mandates, or the creation of a "Permanent Establishment" (PE) under international double-taxation treaties, assigned EoR personnel are subject to strict operational boundaries:

- **Prohibition on Commercial Contracting:** Assigned EoR employees are strictly prohibited from negotiating, executing, amending, or legally binding client entities or Trustora to commercial contracts, sales agreements, or financial obligations with third parties in the local deployment territory.
- **Operational Scope Limits:** Personnel may perform technical development, operations, customer support, and administrative execution as directed by the client, but must not act as a legal commercial agent or general power-of-attorney holder for the client entity.
- **Violation Disciplinary Action:** Any unauthorized execution of commercial contracts or representation that creates legal or tax exposure for Trustora or its client partner will result in immediate suspension, formal investigation, and summary dismissal for cause.

31.4 Co-Employment Clarification and Statutory Liability Allocation

Trustora maintains legal employment status solely for statutory payroll, tax withholding, and HR compliance administration.

- **Supervisory Separation:** Day-to-day management, project timelines, code reviews, and product deliverables are directed exclusively by the client entity.
- **Liability Limitation:** Trustora assumes legal liability for local employment, tax, and labor law compliance. However, Trustora is explicitly held harmless from commercial, product liability, or operational losses resulting directly from tasks performed under client supervision.

32. TECHNICAL CERTIFICATIONS, HARNESS CI/CD INFRASTRUCTURE, AI MODEL GOVERNANCE, AND SMART GIT PROTOCOLS

32.1 Mandatory Professional Certifications and Technical Upskilling

To maintain high technical benchmarks across global client deployments, all engineering, technical, and client-assigned personnel must actively pursue and maintain role-specific technical certifications.

- **Continuous Certification Baseline:** Personnel are required to complete designated skill certifications (including cloud architecture, software engineering, AI/ML deployment, and DevOps frameworks) as assigned in their annual development plans or required by client Master Services Agreements (MSAs).
- **Compliance Requirement:** Proof of certification renewal or milestone completion must be submitted periodically to info@trustora.net to maintain active placement eligibility.

32.2 Harness Architecture and Deployment Pipeline Mastery

All technical staff involved in software development, infrastructure, or deployment pipelines must demonstrate proficiency in the **Harness** deployment platform and associated Continuous Integration/Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) tooling:

- **Pipeline Execution:** Engineers must understand how Harness pipeline automation, continuous verification, security governance, and feature flag controls function within client codebases.
- **Release Security:** Unapproved manual overrides of automated Harness security checks or deployment gates are strictly prohibited.

32.3 Artificial Intelligence Framework and Model Competency

As AI-driven capabilities integrate into modern workflows, technical staff must maintain a foundational understanding of core AI architecture and execution principles:

- **Model Understanding:** Personnel working on or alongside AI systems must understand underlying model workflows, input/output structures, data handling parameters, and inference pipelines.
- **Responsible AI & Safety:** Implementation of AI models or AI-assisted automation must strictly align with corporate data privacy standards, ensuring zero leakage of client PII or proprietary source code into public training sets.

32.4 Mandatory Git Version Control Protocols and SMART Commit Standards

All code contributions, repository modifications, script releases, and technical documentation updates must strictly adhere to standardized Git protocols and version control governance.

SMART Commit Methodology

Every code commit pushed to corporate or client repositories must follow the **SMART Commit** convention to guarantee clear software auditability:

32.5 Universal Compliance and Zero Trust Integration

Adherence to these technical standards, certification updates, Harness CI/CD workflows, AI safety guidelines, SMART Git commit protocols, and Zero Trust security policies is **mandatory across all operational roles**. Failure to follow these protocols degrades code quality, increases security vulnerability, and will result in immediate code review rejection, platform access suspension, and formal performance management review.